

User guide

Make A4 flyers with QR codes for your library, step by step

A step-by-step guide. You don't need any technical knowledge.

What is this?

Library flyer maker helps you make a one-page A4 flyer about the services of your library. Every service gets a QR code. Readers scan the code with their phone and go straight to the right web page.

- It is free, and it will stay free.
- There is nothing to install. The tool is a single file that opens in your web browser.
- Everything stays on your computer. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.



What you need

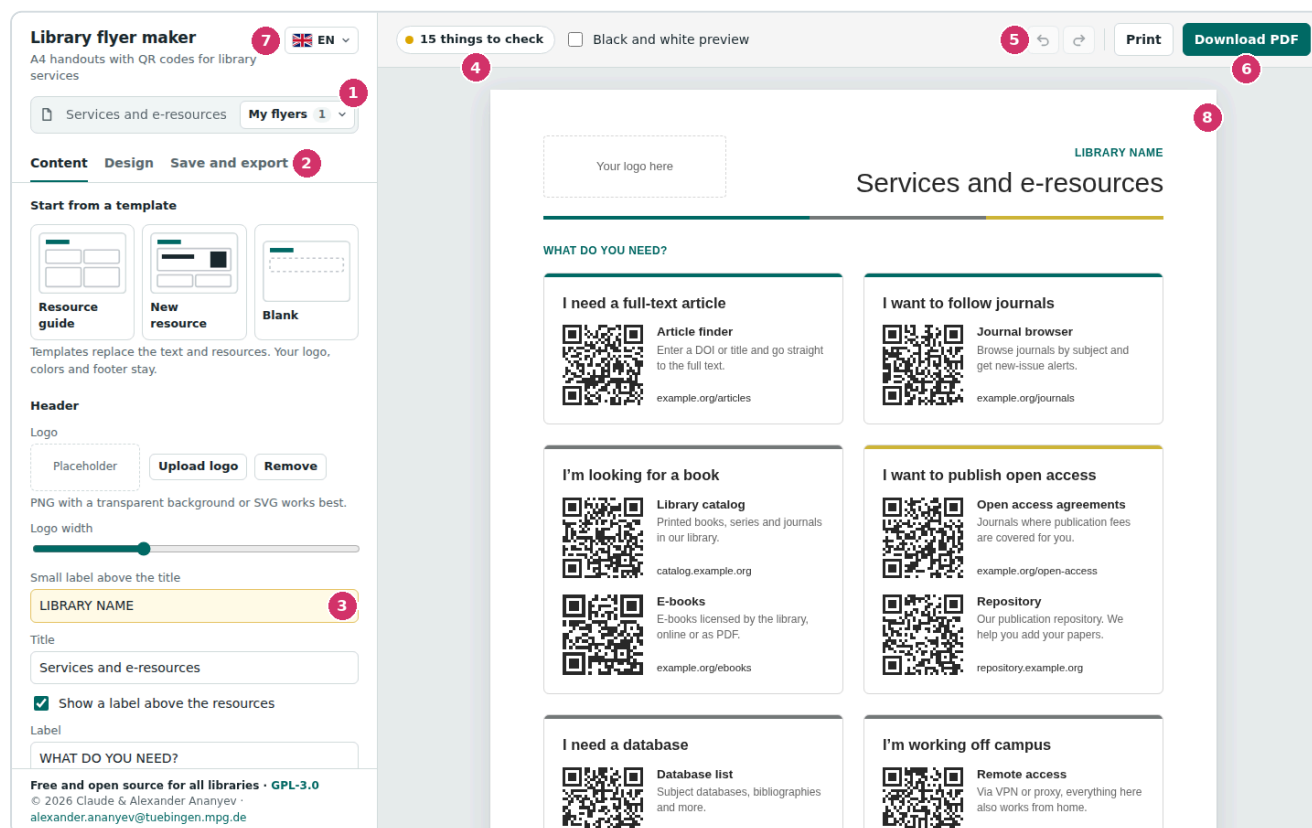
- A computer with an up-to-date web browser: Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari.
- The file **library-flyer-maker.html**.
- Your library logo as an image file (PNG, JPG or SVG). This is optional.
- The web addresses of the services you want to show.

Step 1: Open the tool

1. Save the file **library-flyer-maker.html** somewhere easy to find, for example on your desktop.
2. Double-click the file. It opens in your web browser. If it opens in a different program, right-click the file, choose **Open with** and pick your web browser.
3. You now see an example flyer. Everything on it is an example that you will replace with your own details.

Tip: To change the language of the buttons (English, Deutsch, Русский), click the flag at the top left.

Step 2: Find your way around



1. **Flyer name and My flyers.** The name of the flyer you are working on, and the list of all your flyers.
2. **Tabs.** *Content* for texts and links, *Design* for colors and layout, *Save and export* for files.
3. **Fields.** Type here to change the flyer. A yellow field still contains example text.
4. **Check button.** Tells you what still needs your attention. Click it to see the list.
5. **Undo and Redo.** Take back your last change, or bring it back again.
6. **Print** and **Download PDF.**
7. **Language** of the buttons.
8. **Preview.** Shows your flyer exactly as it will be printed. It changes while you type.

Step 3: Add your library's details

Everything in this step is on the **Content** tab.

1. **Logo:** Click **Upload logo** and choose your logo file. Use the **Logo width** slider to make it bigger or smaller. If you don't want a logo, click **Remove**.
2. **Small label above the title:** Type the name of your library.
3. **Title:** For example "Services and e-resources".
4. **Footer:** Scroll down to the end of the Content tab. Enter your address, e-mail address, phone number and opening hours.

Fields with a **yellow background** still contain example text. The yellow disappears as soon as you type your own text.

Step 4: Add your services

The flyer is made of **sections**, for example "I'm looking for a book". Each section contains one or more **resources**, for example "Library catalog".

Click a section heading to open it. For each resource, fill in:

- **Name:** short, for example "Library catalog".
- **Description:** one or two short lines. The small counter shows how much space you have, for example 54/60.
- **Link:** the web address of the service. The easiest way: open the page in your browser, click into the address bar at the top, copy the address (**Ctrl+C**, on a Mac **⌘C**) and paste it into this field (**Ctrl+V**, on a Mac **⌘V**). You can also enter an e-mail address or a phone number.
- **Printed address** (optional): a shorter version of the address to print under the description. Leave it empty to print the link itself.

The QR code is created automatically.

- **A:** Hold and drag here to move the resource to another place, also into another section.
- **B:** Move the resource up or down, make a copy, or delete it.
- **C:** Open the link in a new tab to check that it works.

More things you can do:

- **Add resource** adds a new resource to a section. **Add section** (below the last section) adds a new section.
- Each section has a **heading** and a **color**. The small buttons next to the section heading move, copy or delete the whole section.
- **Box at the bottom:** an optional box for a contact, for example for interlibrary loan. Untick **Show the box** if you don't need it.
- **Start from a template** (at the top of the Content tab) gives you a different starting point: *Resource guide*, *New resource* or *Blank*. A template replaces the texts and resources. Your logo, colors and footer stay.

Resource 1 14/34

Name
Article finder

Description 54/60
Enter a DOI or title and go straight to the full text.

Link or text for the QR code **C**
<https://example.org/articles>

Printed address (optional)
example.org/articles

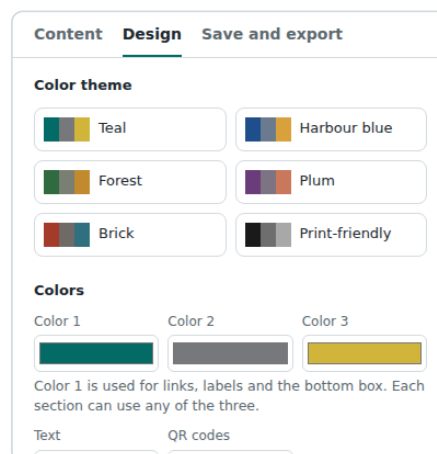
Leave empty to print the link itself. Use a shorter form for long links.

☒ Show QR code

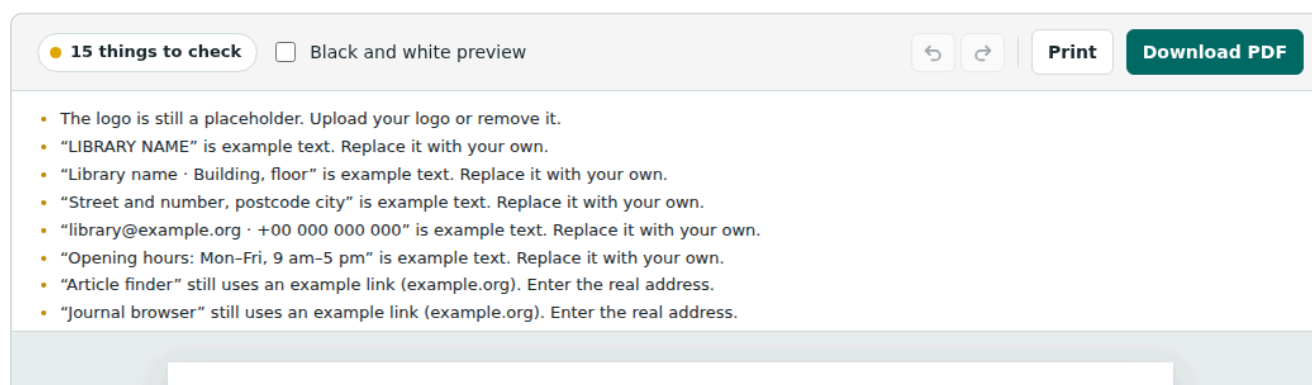
Step 5: Choose the look

Open the **Design** tab.

- **Color theme:** Click a theme to change all colors at once. You can also pick your own colors under **Colors**.
- **Background:** White is best for printing.
- **Layout:** *Two columns* suits most flyers. *Wide rows* suits sections with many resources. *Spotlight* shows the first resource very large, for example to announce something new.
- **Language of the flyer:** Choose the language your flyer is written in, so that long words are split correctly at the end of a line.
- **QR code size:** *Medium* works well. Choose *Small* if the content doesn't fit on one page.



Step 6: Check your flyer



The check button at the top tells you whether the flyer is ready:

- **Green, "Ready to print":** Everything looks good.
- **Yellow, "... things to check":** There is still example text or an example link (example.org), or something may not look right.
- **Red, "... issues to fix":** For example, the content doesn't fit on one A4 page, or a QR code can't be scanned.

Click the button to open the list. Resources that need your attention have a yellow frame on the Content tab.

Test the QR codes: Point your phone camera at a QR code in the preview on your screen. Your phone should offer to open the right page.

Black and white preview (next to the check button) shows how the flyer will look on a black-and-white printer.

Step 7: Print or save as PDF

- **Download PDF** (top right): best for e-mail and for your website. The links in the PDF can be clicked.
- **Print** (top right): sends the flyer to your printer. In the print window, choose **A4** paper and **100 %** (or "Actual size"). If colors or lines are missing, switch on **Background graphics** (in Chrome under *More settings*).
- **Download image (PNG)** (on the *Save and export* tab): for screens, your intranet or social media.

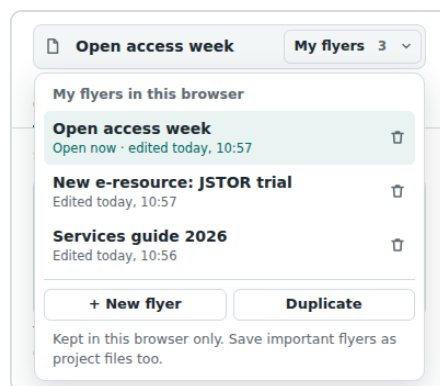
The files get the name of your flyer, which you can change at the top of the panel.

Step 8: Your work is saved automatically

Every change is kept in your web browser. When you open the file again later, your last flyer is there.

My flyers: Click **My flyers** at the top to see all your flyers.

- Click a flyer to open it.
- **+ New flyer** starts a new flyer that already has your logo, colors and footer.
- **Duplicate** makes a copy of the open flyer.
- The **bin** deletes a flyer. Clicked it by mistake? Click **Undo** in the message at the bottom of the screen.
- To **rename** a flyer, click its name in the bar at the top and type.



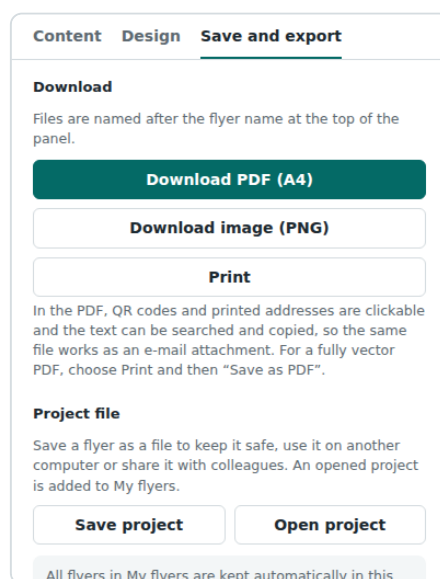
Keep a backup and share with colleagues

Your flyers are kept **only in this browser on this computer**. You won't see them in another browser, on another computer or in a private window. They are also lost if the browser data is deleted.

So for flyers that matter, keep a backup:

1. Open the **Save and export** tab.
2. Click **Save project**. A small file ending in **.json** is downloaded. Keep it somewhere safe.

To continue on another computer, or to give a flyer to a colleague, send the **.json** file together with **library-flyer-maker.html**. On the other computer, click **Open project** and choose the .json file. The flyer is added to *My flyers* there.



Made a mistake?

Click **Undo** (the curved arrow at the top right) or press **Ctrl+Z** (on a Mac **⌘Z**). To bring a change back, click **Redo** or press **Ctrl+Y** (on a Mac **⌘Y**).

Each flyer remembers its own changes as long as the page stays open.

To start again from the beginning: **Save and export** tab → **Start over with the example**. You can undo this, too.

Questions and answers

My flyer is gone! You probably opened the tool in a different browser, on a different computer or in a private window. Open it again in the browser you used before, or click **Open project** and choose your saved .json file.

The content doesn't fit on one page. Shorten the descriptions, remove a resource, choose *Small* QR codes on the Design tab, or switch to *Two columns*.

A QR code doesn't scan. Use dark QR codes on a white background, choose a larger QR code size, and use a shorter link if you can.

Some of our links only work inside our network. That's fine, but readers outside need VPN. The check list reminds you of such links.

Do I need an internet connection? No. The tool works offline. Of course, your readers need internet on their phones to open the links.

Is my data sent anywhere? No. Texts, links and logos stay on your computer.

Does it cost anything? No. The tool is free and open source (GNU General Public License, version 3). You are welcome to pass it on to other libraries.

Where can I get help or suggest an idea? Write to alexander.ananyev@tuebingen.mpg.de.